The Heirloom Garden Kit

Seeds, Sunshine & the Joy of Watching Things Grow

INSIDE THIS KIT

- Conversation Cards
- Word Link Game
- Musical Memory
- Trivia Time
- BINGO
- *Bonus:* Visual Spark Cards

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Why This Kit Works For You & Your Residents

Designed for real Activity Directors who need meaningful engagement without hours of prep.

Recognition Over Recall

Residents are not put on the spot to “remember.” Instead, familiar themes, visuals, and prompts gently spark recognition, allowing participation without pressure.

Dignified & Adult-Centric

Every activity is designed for adults — not childish or overly simplified. The tone, topics, and visuals respect life experience and identity.

Multi-Sensory Engagement

This kit blends conversation, visuals, music, and group interaction to engage different cognitive pathways. Residents can participate in the way that feels most natural to them.

Adaptable for All Abilities

Activities can be used 1:1, in small groups, or larger settings. You can scale up or down depending on cognitive level, energy, and time available.

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How to Run This Session

No prep. No guesswork. Just follow the flow.

YOUR DONE-FOR-YOU SESSION FLOW · 45–60 MINUTES

1

WARM UP

Conversation Cards

5–10 minutes

Gently open the session with familiar, low-pressure prompts. Encourages comfort, participation, and initial connection.

2

ENGAGE

Visual Spark Cards

10–15 minutes

Use imagery to trigger recognition, storytelling, and memory. Ideal for residents who respond better to visuals than direct questions.

3

CONNECT

BINGO or Trivia

15–20 minutes

Bring energy into the room with structured group interaction. Encourages laughter, participation, and shared experiences.

4

EMOTIONAL CLOSE

Musical Memory

10 minutes

End the session with music-based prompts or familiar songs. Creates emotional connection, calm, and a meaningful finish.

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What's Included in Your Kit

Everything you need to run multiple engaging sessions — without creating content from scratch.

6 ACTIVITIES · MULTIPLE SESSIONS · ZERO PREP

Conversation Cards
Thoughtfully written prompts that spark stories and memories. Works in group and one-on-one settings.

Visual Spark Cards
Image-based prompts that trigger recognition and emotional recall. Ideal for residents who respond better to visuals.

Trivia Game
Curated questions based on familiar themes and shared cultural experiences. Encourages participation, not frustration.

Word Link Game
Engaging word association activity that stimulates cognition in a low-pressure way. Works across all ability levels.

BINGO Activity
A familiar game adapted with meaningful, recognizable themes. Encourages group interaction and energy.

Musical Memory
Song and lyric-based activities that tap into emotional memory. Perfect for connection and ending on a high note.

TOTAL VALUE

Multiple activities. Multiple sessions. Use this kit again and again without repeating the same experience.

"Designed to save you hours of planning — while delivering meaningful, dignified engagement."

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SECTION 1

CONVERSATION CARDS

CONVERSATION STARTERS — CUT, LAMINATE & ENJOY

Getting Your Hands in the Dirt

A-1

"Did you grow up with a garden in the yard? Who tended it — was it your mother, your father, a grandparent? What do you remember about watching them work in it?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

A-2

"What did the soil smell like after a good rain? Do you remember the feeling of cool, damp earth in your hands when you were planting something for the first time?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

A-3

"Did you ever start seeds indoors in little pots on a windowsill and wait for the first green shoot to appear? What was the excitement like when something finally sprouted?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

The Vegetable Patch

B-1

"What vegetables did your family grow? Tomatoes, green beans, cucumbers, squash? Was there one thing that grew so well you had more than you could ever eat?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

B-2

"Do you remember picking a ripe tomato right off the vine, still warm from the sun, and eating it right there in the garden? What did it taste like compared to a store-bought one?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

B-3

"Did your family can or preserve anything from the garden — tomatoes, pickles, jam, green beans? What was that process like, and who was in charge of it?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Flowers & Favorites

C-1

"What flowers did you love the most — roses, peonies, lilacs, marigolds, zinnias? Was there a flower whose scent can still take you right back to a specific place or time?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

C-2

"Did anyone you know have a spectacular garden that the whole neighborhood admired? What made it so special — the colors, the neatness, one particular showstopper plant?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

C-3

"Did you ever pick wildflowers from a field or a roadside and bring them home in a jar? Where did you put them, and who were they for?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Tools of the Trade

D-1

"What garden tools do you remember using — a hoe, a hand trowel, pruning shears, a push mower? Did you have a favorite tool that felt just right in your hand?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

D-2

"Did your family have a garden shed, a potting bench, or a corner of the garage full of pots and supplies? What did it look like in there, and what did it smell like?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

D-3

"Did you have a specific place where you kept your gardening tools—a potting bench, a shed, or a pegboard? What did it smell like, and were you the type to clean and sharpen your tools after every use, or put them away covered in dirt?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Time Spent Outside

E-1

"What was the best part of spending a whole afternoon outside — the warmth of the sun, the sound of birds, the breeze, the smell of fresh-cut grass? What made you feel most at peace in the yard?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

E-2

"Did you have a favorite spot to sit outside — a porch swing, a lawn chair under a shade tree, a bench by the garden? What did you see and hear from that spot?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

E-3

"Did your neighbors ever share vegetables, cuttings, or gardening advice over the fence? Was there a sense of friendly competition about whose garden looked best?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

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SECTION 2

VISUAL SPARK CARDS

IMAGE-BASED CONVERSATION STARTERS — CUT, LAMINATE & SHARE

SPARK 1

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 2

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 3

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 4

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 5

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 6

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 7

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 8

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 9

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 10

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

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SECTION 3

TRIVIA TIME

20 QUESTIONS — GARDENS, GROWING & THE GREAT OUTDOORS

In the Garden (Questions 1–5)

1. What common garden tool with a long handle and a flat, angled blade is used to break up soil and chop weeds between rows of plants?

Answer: A hoe

2. What red, wriggly creatures that live in the soil are considered a gardener's best friend because they aerate the earth and enrich it naturally?

Answer: Earthworms (or worms)

3. What material — such as straw, wood chips, or leaves — do gardeners spread on top of the soil to keep moisture in and weeds down?

Answer: Mulch

4. What garden feature, usually made of stone, ceramic, or concrete and filled with water, is designed to attract songbirds to the yard?

Answer: A birdbath

5. What large, round-headed yellow flower, famous for turning its face to follow the sun across the sky, can grow taller than a person?

Answer: A sunflower

Flowers & Blooms (Questions 6–10)

6. What fragrant purple flower, beloved for its heavenly spring scent, grows on a bush and was often found near the front porch or along a fence?

Answer: Lilac

7. What thorny flower, known as the 'Queen of the Garden,' comes in red, pink, yellow, and white and has been a symbol of love for centuries?

Answer: The rose

8. What cheerful, round orange and yellow flowers were commonly planted along garden borders because their strong scent helps keep pests away?

Answer: Marigolds

9. What tall, stately flower with large trumpet-shaped blooms comes from a bulb, is associated with Easter, and fills a room with its perfume?

Answer: A lily (Easter lily)

10. What spring flower grows from a bulb planted in the fall, comes in nearly every color, and is famously associated with Holland?

Answer: A tulip

Fruits & Vegetables (Questions 11–15)

11. What popular garden vegetable, often grown on a vine tied to a stake or cage, is technically a fruit and is the most commonly homegrown produce in America?

Answer: The tomato

12. What long, green, crunchy vegetable grows on a vine, is mostly water, and is a classic ingredient in summer salads and pickles?

Answer: A cucumber

13. What sweet red fruit, low to the ground on small leafy plants, is one of the first treats ready to pick in early summer?

Answer: A strawberry

14. What large orange vegetable, grown on a sprawling vine, is carved into a jack-o'-lantern every October and baked into pies every November?

Answer: A pumpkin

15. What fragrant herb with narrow green leaves and a piney scent is a kitchen staple, often grown in a pot by the back door, and pairs beautifully with roasted chicken?

Answer: Rosemary

Garden Wisdom & Traditions (Questions 16–20)

16. According to the old saying, what do April showers bring?

Answer: May flowers

17. What human-shaped figure, usually made from old clothes stuffed with straw and mounted on a pole, is placed in a garden to frighten birds away from the crops?

Answer: A scarecrow

18. If someone is said to have a 'green' what, it means they have a natural talent for making things grow?

Answer: A green thumb

19. What beloved annual tradition, held by garden clubs and communities across the country, is a competitive event where people display their best roses, vegetables, and preserves for ribbons and prizes?

Answer: A garden show (or county fair / flower show)

20. What tiny, dome-shaped beetle, usually red or orange with black spots, is considered good luck in the garden because it eats aphids and other harmful pests?

Answer: A ladybug

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SECTION 4

WORD LINK GAME

FIND THE BRIDGE WORD

Read the two outside words aloud. Residents find the single "bridge word" that fits in the blank to complete a familiar compound word or phrase on BOTH sides.

#	LEFT WORD	BRIDGE WORD	RIGHT WORD
1	SUN	_____	POT
2	GREEN	_____	WORK
3	RAIN	_____	FALL
4	SEED	_____	ROCK
5	BUTTER	_____	CAKE
6	GRASS	_____	MARK
7	ROCK	_____	HOSE
8	PINE	_____	SAUCE
9	BACK	_____	STICK
10	SCARE	_____	BAR
11	SPRING	_____	WALK
12	HONEY	_____	LINE
13	DAY	_____	HOUSE
14	HEDGE	_____	BOAT

#	LEFT WORD	BRIDGE WORD	RIGHT WORD
15	**DOOR**	_____	**LADDER**

Answer Key

1. FLOWER	2. HOUSE	3. WATER
4. BED	5. CUP	6. LAND
7. GARDEN	8. APPLE	9. YARD
10. CROW	11. BOARD	12. BEE
13. LIGHT	14. ROW	15. STEP

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The Heirloom Garden Kit BINGO

Mark each square as it's called · Five in a row wins!

B	I	N	G	O
Flower Pot	Garden Hose	Wind Chime	Rose Bush	Sunflower
Seed Packet	Scarecrow	Tomato Plant	Watering Can	Garden Gloves
Hummingbird	Picket Fence	FREE SPACE	Wheelbarrow	Worm
Herb Garden	Bird Bath	Pruning Shears	Lawn Mower	Compost Pile
Vegetable Patch	Porch Swing	Rain Barrel	Trellis	Sprinkler

Print one copy per resident · Use coins, buttons, or markers to cover squares

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BINGO Facilitation Guide

BONUS ENGAGEMENT PROMPTS · FOR THE FACILITATOR ONLY

When someone calls “Garden Hose”
Did you ever get sprayed with the garden hose on a hot summer day — on purpose or by accident? Who was holding the hose, and did it start a water fight?

When someone calls “Tomato Plant”
There's nothing like a homegrown tomato. Did your family grow them? Do you remember that deep, earthy smell of the tomato vine on your hands after picking one?

When someone calls “Scarecrow”
Did anyone in your family ever make a scarecrow? What did you dress it in, and did it actually keep the birds away — or did they just ignore it?

When someone calls “Lawn Mower”
Who mowed the lawn at your house? Was it a push mower you could hear clicking, or a gas-powered one? Do you remember the smell of fresh-cut grass on a Saturday morning?

When someone calls “Bird Bath”
Did you have a birdbath in the yard? What kinds of birds came to visit? Did you ever sit and watch them splash around in it?

When someone calls “Seed Packet”
Do you remember choosing seed packets at the hardware store or from a catalog? Those beautiful pictures on the front — did what you grew ever look as perfect as the packet promised?

When someone calls “Porch Swing”
Did you have a porch swing or a glider? Was it a favorite spot to sit in the evening, maybe with a glass of iced tea, watching the lightning bugs come out?

When someone calls “Sunflower”
Did you ever grow sunflowers? They shoot up so tall so fast — did you measure them, or did the kids stand next to them to compare height? Did you save the seeds?

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SECTION 6

MUSICAL MEMORY

Part A: Finish the Lyric

Read the artist name and the beginning of the lyric. Residents complete the missing word or phrase.

Jimmie Davis (1940)

You Are My Sunshine

"You are my sunshine, my only ___"

Answer: Sunshine

The Beatles (1969)

Here Comes the Sun

"Here comes the sun, and I say it's all ___"

Answer: Right

B.J. Thomas (1969)

Raindrops Keep Fallin' on My Head

"Raindrops keep fallin' on my ___"

Answer: Head

Louis Armstrong (1967)

What a Wonderful World

"I see trees of green, red roses ___"

Answer: Too

Tiny Tim (1968)

Tiptoe Through the Tulips

"Tiptoe through the ___ with me"

Answer: Tulips

Gene Kelly (1952)

Singin' in the Rain

“I'm singin' in the rain, just singin' in the ___”

Answer: Rain

Part B: Name That Garden Tune

Read the clue. Residents name the song.

B-1

"Johnny Nash's uplifting 1972 hit is all about a bright new day. The rain is gone, the obstacles are out of the way, and he's feeling like nothing but blue skies are ahead."

Answer: "I Can See Clearly Now" (Johnny Nash, 1972)

B-2

"The Beatles recorded this cheerful 1966 track celebrating a beautiful sunny day that makes you want to laugh and feel fine. The whole song is a love letter to perfect weather."

Answer: "Good Day Sunshine" (The Beatles, 1966)

B-3

"The Foundations had a huge 1968 hit about someone who keeps letting them down. The title includes the name of a small yellow wildflower you might find in a meadow."

Answer: "Build Me Up Buttercup" (The Foundations, 1968)

B-4

"Cream's 1967 psychedelic rock classic is a love song with a title that combines warm weather and a bright celestial body. Eric Clapton's guitar riff is one of the most famous in rock history."

Answer: "Sunshine of Your Love" (Cream, 1967)

B-5

"The Drifters' smooth 1962 hit is about escaping the noise and the crowds by climbing up to a quiet spot above the city, where you can see the stars and feel the breeze — a rooftop paradise."

Answer: "Up on the Roof" (The Drifters, 1962)

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